

film review Great Chemistry

PARTNER

Director: David Dhawan
Starring: Govinda, Salman Khan, Katrina Kaif, Lara Dutta

At one point in *Partner*, Salman Khan, playing the uber-cool "date doctor" Love Guru, is trying to teach Govinda, playing the supreme geek Bhaskar Deewaker Chaudhary, how to dance. The love guru tries to make Chaudhary imitate his smooth moves to a hit nightclub song from an earlier Khan movie: *Just chill, chill, just chill*. But Chaudhary re-lapses into what he loves best: *Sarkailo khatiya*,



jaada lage. It's a superbly funny moment that encapsulates the difference between the two actors and their worlds.

Partner is the pedestrian version of Will Smith's engaging romantic comedy, *Hitch*, minus its grace and wit. But Govinda and Khan have a great chemistry. If you can

ignore the total lack of consistency and logic, the infantile digs at gay men and the generally juvenile tone of the film, *Partner*, pre-interval, is great fun. It doesn't have the virtuoso inanity of the best of David Dhawan-Govinda films, but it has its moments. The rest is cacophony.

by Anupama Chopra

recommendations Monsoon Magic

MUMBAI Ten artists present their works on a variety of themes and media, depicting the varied moods the rains stand for. Suhas Roy presents an oil-on-canvas of a man and woman entwined in a dance of love in shades of blue and grey while Ashok Salian exhibits countless photographs shot over years. Krishna Pulkundwar's abstracts are well-defined spaces with strong geometric lines in reds, blacks, ochre and blues. Amrutraj Koban from Latur showcases his Buddha holding a lotus, seated to achieve nirvana. Images of dancers and



Prakash's nature drummers performing at the village celebrations exude a feeling of rhythm and energy while Surya Prakash paints nature in the dramatic colours of fall—warm reds, yellows and oranges. On till August 5.

by Aditi Pai

BANGALORE Celebrating its 10th year of producing grand musicals, the Cooperation of the Arts for the Underprivileged in Society and the Environment Foundation presents the technicolour *Dreamcoat* directed by Laila Alvares. The theatrical creation is a spoof on the biblical story of Joseph and his brothers. Directed by the likes of Andrew Lloyd-Webber and hundreds of other directors and musicians, this is one of the most loved musicals ever produced using elaborate sets and properties. The play will stage the best of Bangalore's music and theatre talent. From August 3-6 at Chowdaiah Memorial Hall.

by Nirmala Ravindran

music reviews On a Prayer

OM JAI JAGDISH HARE



Music Today
Rs 225

Om Jai Jagdish Hare is the most popular aarti sung during prayers in north India.

Even the Christian church has adapted it in their Sunday services. And let's not forget it is the Bollywood's favourite bhajan, sung by everybody, from Lata Mangeshkar to Mahendra Kapoor. This album has six versions of the aarti, the original sung by a chorus. Interpretations by Shankar Mahadevan (vocal), Sunil Das (sitar), Ronu Mazumdar (flute), Ashit, Hema Desai (vocal). Soothing music for those prayerful moments.

MORNING MELODIES



HMV
Rs 150

This album is for all those who like instrumental versions of devotional songs. The artistes are

Sawan Dutta on the piano and Ajay Prasanna playing the flute. Both have complemented each other with their lilting and foot-tapping melodies, playing the instrumental versions of film songs such as *Jaise suraj ki garmi se* (Parinay); *Hum ko maan ki shakti dena* (Guddi) and chants like *He Ram*, *Govind bolo Hari Gopal bolo* and *Om namah shivaya*. However, the percussions could have been a little more classier.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

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